Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ J 6
♦ A 6 4
♣ Q J 10 8 7

♠ 9 8 5 3 2
♥ 10 5 4 3
♦ J 10
♣ 5 4

♠ A J 10 4
♥ A 9
♦ 9 8 7 5 3 2
♣ 2

♠ 6
♥ K Q 8 7 2
♦ K Q
♣ A K 9 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2♣	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♣ by North
Lead: ♥A

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, SOUTH has no problem as long as NORTH holds at least one Key-card. When NORTH responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), SOUTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2
♥ 4
♦ K 6
♣ A K 5

♠ 4
♥ 9 7 5 2
♦ 9 5 4 3
♣ 8 7 4 2

♠ 10 3
♥ A K 8 6
♦ 10 8 7 2
♣ 10 6 3

♠ A 9 6
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ A Q J
♣ Q J 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

NORTH needs to know how many Aces SOUTH holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K Q 8 7 4 3 ♥ Q 7 5 ♦ — ♣ 9 7 6 2	
♠ 2 ♥ J 10 9 3 ♦ Q J 9 7 4 3 ♣ 8 5		♠ 9 6 ♥ 8 6 4 2 ♦ A 10 8 6 2 ♣ 10 3
	♠ A J 10 5 ♥ A K ♦ K 5 ♣ A K Q J 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♦	Pass	7♠
All Pass			

7♠ by North
Lead: ♦A

NORTH's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

SOUTH figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

NORTH's 6♦ reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King, and a ♦ void!.

SOUTH readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

Board 4
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K Q 3 ♥ K 10 9 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ K Q 9 6	
♠ 10 9 5 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 5 2 ♣ J 10 5 4 2		♠ J 8 7 2 ♥ J ♦ J 10 9 8 7 4 ♣ A 3
	♠ A 6 ♥ A Q 8 7 5 2 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦5

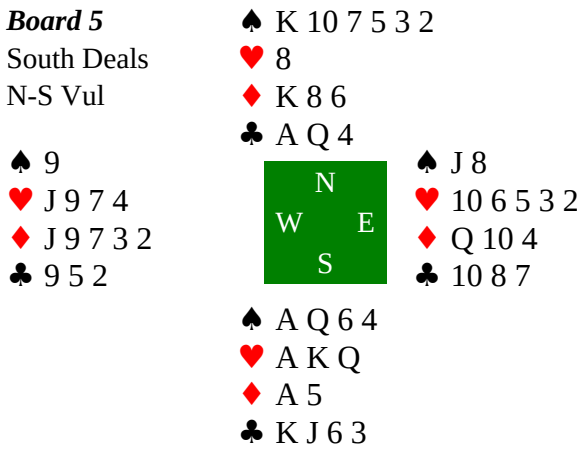
SOUTH jumps in ♥s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

NORTH has great ♥ support so bids RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the ♥Q.

That is enough for NORTH to bid the slam.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♣
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

7NT by North
Lead: ♥6

When SOUTH agrees to ♠s, NORTH will not stop short of a slam. The RKCB 4NT bid tells NORTH that they have all five Key Cards since SOUTH could hardly have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

NORTH's 5♥ bid is the Queen Ask, and SOUTH's reply confirms that she holds the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

NORTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

Board 6
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q 8 6 ♥ Q J 3 ♦ A J 5 ♣ A J 6 5	
♠ J 2 ♥ A K 7 5 4 ♦ 10 8 4 ♣ 10 8 7		♠ 10 9 4 ♥ 10 9 6 2 ♦ 9 6 3 ♣ 9 3 2
	♠ A K 7 5 3 ♥ 8 ♦ K Q 7 2 ♣ K Q 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit. NORTH's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when SOUTH claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q. She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).